

Build Steps

Part 1 of 5 — Set up the agent, orchestration, and knowledge

1 Create Your Copilot Studio Agent

Open Copilot Studio (copilotstudio.microsoft.com), select Create → New agent, then configure:

Agent Name	Store Ops Daily Copilot
Description	Daily store-operations sidekick — sales vs target, footfall, conversion, NPS movement, staffing gaps, top product gaps; drafts the daily store stand-up note.
Solution / Environment	Consumer Experience · Default environment
Icon	Use a recognisable colour and emoji or upload a brand icon

2 Choose Orchestration Mode

Under Settings → Generative AI, choose how the agent decides what to do:

Generative Orchestration

Recommended — AI-led

- Agent reasons over user input and picks the right topic, tool, or knowledge
- Handles paraphrases, multi-step asks, and follow-ups naturally
- Best for varied user intent and exploratory questions
- Requires clear instructions, tool descriptions, and good knowledge

Classic Orchestration

Deterministic — trigger-led

- Topics fire on explicit trigger phrases you author
- Predictable flows, easier to audit step-by-step
- Best for tightly-scoped, regulated, or compliance-critical journeys
- Less forgiving of phrasing the author didn't anticipate

For this build we use Generative Orchestration so the agent can blend knowledge lookups with tool calls for store operations and daily stand-up.

3 Add Knowledge

Go to the Knowledge tab → Add knowledge → File, then upload `Consumer_StoreOps_Data.xlsx`. This file contains:

- Store metadata (store ID, store name, date)
- Traffic and sales (footfall count, conversion %, sales USD, sales vs target %)
- Customer signal (NPS score)
- Staffing (staff on shift, staff required, top gap, free-text stand-up note)

You can layer additional sources later — SharePoint sites, Dataverse, public web, or Graph connectors.

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Part 2 of 5 — Add instructions and a custom topic

4 Add Agent Instructions

Open Overview → Instructions and paste the following (these guide the model regardless of orchestration mode):

You are the Store Ops Daily Copilot. You help two audiences:

- 1) Store managers running today's stand-up.
- 2) Regional managers comparing performance across stores.

Rules:

- Use the uploaded store ops dataset as your single source of truth.
- Keep replies brisk and action-led – managers are on the shop floor.
- For every store metric, lead with movement vs target (the 'so what').
- For the daily stand-up draft, call the 'Send Stand-up Note to Teams' tool rather than producing it as plain text.
- Flag any store where $\text{SalesVsTargetPct} < -10\%$ or $\text{StaffOnShift} < \text{StaffRequired}$.
- Treat staffing data as confidential – managers see their store, regionals see their patch.

5 Add a Custom Topic

Go to Topics → Add a topic → Create from description. Topics are reusable conversation flows the agent can call when intent matches.

Topic name: Draft Today's Store Stand-up

Description: Pulls today's store row, drafts a 4-line stand-up note (sales vs target, conversion, NPS movement, top gap) and offers to post it to the store's Teams channel.

Trigger phrases (Generative Orchestration uses these as intent hints, Classic mode uses them as exact triggers):

- Draft today's stand-up
- Stand-up note for store 014
- Write the morning brief
- Give me today's store update

Conversation steps:

- Identify the store (default to authenticated user's store) and today's date
- Pull today's row plus yesterday's row for comparison
- Compose 4 lines: Sales vs target · Conversion movement · NPS movement · Top gap
- Read the draft back to the manager; allow one round of edits
- Call 'Send Stand-up Note to Teams' to post into the store's team channel
- Confirm message link returned by the tool

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Part 3 of 5 — Add a tool and configure settings

6 Add a Tool

Tools let the agent take an action, not just answer. Go to Tools → Add a tool, and choose one of:

- Prebuilt connector (Outlook, Teams, SharePoint, Dataverse, ServiceNow, etc.)
- Power Automate cloud flow (custom logic you author or already own)
- Custom HTTP request (any REST API your agent can reach)
- Model Context Protocol (MCP) server — for richer tool ecosystems

Tool name: Send Stand-up Note to Teams

Type: Microsoft Teams connector (Post message in channel) + SharePoint archive write

Description: Posts the daily stand-up note as an adaptive card in the store's Teams channel and archives it to the store ops SharePoint library.

Inputs the agent will collect or infer:

- Store ID (from authenticated user)
- Date (defaults to today)
- Headline metric (string – typically Sales vs target %)
- Stand-up body (4-line markdown string)
- Top action for the day (string)

Outcome: Returns the Teams message link and SharePoint archive URL – the manager can re-share or refer back later in the day.

7 Configure Settings

Open the Settings cog (top right). Configure these four areas before you let real users near the agent:

- General — confirm name, description, and primary language
- Generative AI — orchestration mode and content moderation level (start at Medium)
- Authentication — use 'Authenticate with Microsoft' so the agent runs as the signed-in user
- Security — review DLP policy, enabled channels, and end-user authentication

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Part 4 of 5 — Evaluate, test, and publish to a channel

8 Evaluate Your Agent

Go to Analytics → Evaluations → New evaluation. Build a test set so you can measure quality before and after every change.

Test set name: Store Ops Daily Copilot – Baseline v1
Approach: Pair each input prompt with an expected outcome.
Run the evaluation and review three scores per response:

- Groundedness – did the answer stay inside the knowledge?
- Relevance – did it actually address the question?
- Accuracy – did it match the expected outcome?

Sample evaluation items:

Input: Which stores are below -10% vs target today?
Expect: Filters where SalesVsTargetPct < -10 for today; cites StoreID and StoreName.

Input: Show the NPS movement for store 014 over the last week
Expect: Returns store 014 rows for last 7 days, calculates day-over-day NPS deltas.

Input: Draft and send today's stand-up for store 014
Expect: Triggers Draft Today's Store Stand-up topic and calls Send Stand-up Note to Teams.

9 Test in the Test Pane

Use the Test pane (right side of the canvas) while you build. For each query, click Activity map to inspect what the agent did:

- Which topic, tool, or knowledge source fired (and in what order)
- Inputs the agent collected and outputs the tool returned
- Citations linking each answer back to a row of your knowledge file
- Latency per step — useful when tuning multi-tool flows

10 Publish to a Channel

When you're happy, click Publish (top right). Then open Channels and enable the surface your users live in. Recommended for this build: Microsoft Teams — store teams already use it for daily comms.

- Microsoft Teams (mobile) — primary channel for store managers on the floor
- Microsoft 365 Copilot — for regional managers comparing across stores
- Custom website — embed on the store ops intranet for read-only views
- Demo website — useful for showcase or training environments

Teams and M365 Copilot channels require tenant admin approval before users see the agent — plan for that lead time.

Try These Live

Part 5 of 5 — Sample queries to test your agent during the build-along.

Today's Snapshot

How is store 014 tracking vs target so far today?
Which stores are below -10% vs target today?

Trends & Comparisons

Show NPS movement for store 014 over the last week.
Which store has the biggest staffing gap this week?

Governed Action

Draft and send today's stand-up for store 014.
Try a paraphrase: 'fire off the morning huddle note for my store'.

How to Think About This Agent

This agent replaces:

- Manually pulling sales vs target from the BI tool
- Re-typing the stand-up note into Teams every day
- Multiple WhatsApp threads chasing daily numbers

With:

- ✓ Today's numbers and movement in chat
- ✓ Daily stand-up drafted and posted in one turn
- ✓ Cross-store comparisons for regional managers

Trusted, governed, enterprise AI — built once, used everywhere.

Tip for real-world use

Publish to Teams mobile first — store managers run their stand-ups from the shop floor, not a desk. Add a Power BI link in the adaptive card so the team can drill into any metric the stand-up mentions without leaving Teams.

You've built a Copilot Studio agent ✓

You now have an AI agent that can:

- Draft daily stand-up notes
- Compare today vs target instantly
- Surface stores at risk vs target
- Keep the floor moving on the right action